

10 THINGS I WISH YOU KNEW ABOUT LANDING SPEAKING GIGS



HEARD IN AFRICA
WWW.HEARDINAFRICA.COM

INTRODUCTION

Hi my name is Nana an event professional for 7 years now. I have engaged and managed over 400 speakers for events.

I love the event industry so much and this love inspired me to spot a huge problem in the industry, access professional speakers in diverse sectors. Heard In Africa, is a solution to that problem, a leading speaker directory for Africans.

This ebook is designed to help you understand why an event organizer like myself would want to work with you as a speaker at an event.

Trust me, the tips I share in this book will help you understand the mind of an event organizer and meeting planners to help position you as the one they are searching for to get on their stage

***IN THIS BOOK, WILL HELP YOU
UNDERSTAND THE MIND OF
EVENT ORGANIZERS AND
MEETING PLANNERS TO HELP
POSITION YOU AS A SPEAKER
THEY MUST HAVE ON THEIR
STAGE***

The event industry is highly competitive, and with so much talent out there, how do you stand out and secure opportunities to speak on global stages?

In this guide, I share 10 proven tips that have worked for me as an event organizer who designs event content and manages speakers.

I've also gathered insights directly from program managers, sponsors, and decision-makers who choose which speakers make it to their stages.

These strategies will equip you with the tools to elevate your visibility and get noticed by the right people.





BECOME A SUBJECT MATTER EXPERT

Identify what you're passionate about and solve a common problem with your expertise. Share your knowledge consistently on social media to build credibility. An engaged, loyal audience increases your chances of being noticed or referred to event organizers.

**SHARE YOUR KNOWLEDGE
CONSISTENTLY ON SOCIAL MEDIA
TO BUILD CREDIBILITY**

PROMOTE YOURSELF

Be your own cheerleader! Clearly state in your bio on your social media accounts that you're open to speaking opportunities and actively ask your followers for recommendations or connections to event organizers. If you don't ask, no one will know!

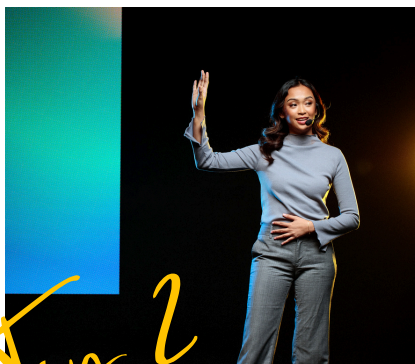
In 2024 I met a lady who transitioned from working a 9-5 job to becoming a public speaker and trainer.

Here are 5 ways she promoted herself:

- a. on social media she talked about her experience in public speaking,
- b. she invited her audience to recommend her or invite her to speak
- c. She shared videos and photos of herself speaking
- d. She shared reviews from event organizers and her audience about her sessions

Guess what?! it worked. It caught my attention and the attention of many other event organizers. I have worked with her for 4 events

**IT WORKED! IT CAUGHT MY
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PITCH YOURSELF TO EVENT ORGANIZERS

Slide into those DMs...send those emails and have a Googlesheet or Excel sheet to track your outreach to event organizers. The more event organizers you reach out to, the higher the chances of you being invited to speak. Don't wait for opportunities to come to you—reach out. When given the chance to speak, express gratitude publicly, share positive reviews of the event, and provide value to the organizer, such as promoting the event to your community.

THRIFT STORES, CONSIGNMENT SHOPS, AND ONLINE MARKETPLACES ARE GREAT PLACES TO FIND CLOTHING



GET A STANDOUT PRESS KIT

A professional press kit (EPK) is a game-changer. Include a polished bio (short, medium, and long), high-quality photos, and a portfolio of past speaking engagements. Always have it ready to share.

IT'S IMPORTANT TO UNDERSTAND THAT BLACK-TIE AND WHITE-TIE EVENTS ARE THE MOST FORMAL



PRIORITIZE EXPERIENCE OVER MONEY (FOR NOW)

My mentor taught me this “Speak more to speak more”
If you're just starting, focus on gaining experience, not payment. Build a portfolio with photos and videos of your engagements, and share highlights on social media. These will pay dividends in credibility later.

SPEAK MORE TO SPEAK MORE



Tip 6

BE GENEROUS

The speakers who leave a lasting impression on me—the ones I always refer and want to work with—are those who bring a spirit of professionalism and a genuine desire to contribute to the success of the event. They go beyond focusing solely on their own performance and actively strive to make the entire event memorable.

It's often in the little things, like offering giveaways during their session. Whether it's a book, a resource, or something meaningful, these gestures showcase thoughtfulness and a true partnership with the event organizers.

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Tip 7

NETWORK, NETWORK, NETWORK

Your network is your net worth. Attend events, introduce yourself to people, and share what you do. Do not leave so early after delivering your talk, stay to connect with attendees—they could become your biggest supporters or lead to your next gig.

DO NOT LEAVE SO EARLY AFTER DELIVERING YOUR TALK, STAY TO CONNECT WITH ATTENDEES...



Tip 8

COLLECT FEEDBACK

How can you truly know if your audience enjoyed your speech or gauge your effectiveness as a speaker? The answer lies in gathering feedback. Use feedback forms or ask your audience directly after your session. Reach out to event organizers and attendees for their input.

Save testimonials, screenshots of comments, and video reviews—these not only enhance your credibility but also provide invaluable insights to help you improve and grow as a speaker.

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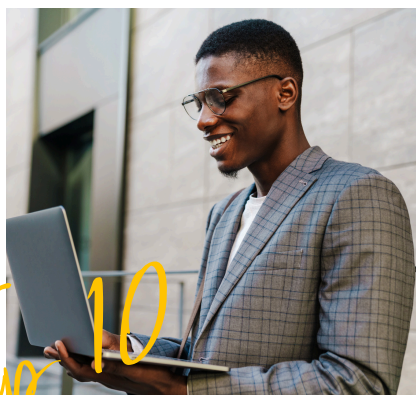


Tip 9

MASTER YOUR CRAFT

Preparation is key. Learn the art of public speaking, storytelling, and audience engagement. Delivering exceptional value on stage ensures you're invited back and recommended to others.

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VICTORY LOVES PREPARATION



Tip 10

JOIN A SPEAKER DIRECTORY

Speaker directories connect you to opportunities. That's why we created Heard In Africa, Africa's leading speaker directory. We're here to connect skilled African speakers to global stages. Join us today—we're rooting for you!

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**HEARD IN AFRICA CONNECTS
EXCEPTIONAL AFRICAN
SPEAKERS TO EVENT
ORGANIZERS**



Bonus Tip

SPEAKER REELS:

Reels are the perfect mix of intrigue and excitement, showcasing your public speaking skills in a way that's hard to ignore. Think of them like a movie trailer—you're the star, and we're the fans watching you shine. Next thing you know, event organizers are booking you, just like moviegoers rushing to the cinema after seeing an epic trailer.

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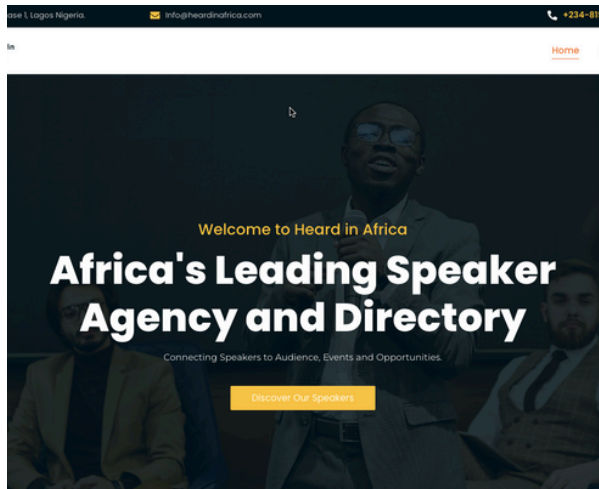
THANK YOU FOR READING!

**Did You Find These Tips Helpful?
If yes, feel free to share this free e-
book with your network!**

At Heard In Africa, we're on a mission to connect African speakers and subject matter experts on the world stage.

This is fresh and new but needed solution to ensure that the perspectives and stories of Africans are heard on stages around the world

JOIN OUR DIRECTORY



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